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CREATING AN IMPACT The institute defines 'wise innovation' as purposeful, done for the right reasons and in the right way and goes beyond novelty. It requires a nuanced understanding of innovation's broader impact and implications

I FOR INNOVATION

At SPJIMR, the focus over the last year has been on innovation, an area that the institute aims to link with societal impact

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN

I **T HAS BEEN** a season of travel for Varun Nagaraj, and he managed to squeeze in time for this interaction. For someone who has spent time studying and working overseas, the last four years as Dean of S.P. Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR) have been

hugely exciting, and he readily admits to that.

For most academics, a pressing concern right now would easily be the widespread use of artificial intelligence (AI). There are several nuances to this as the world attempts to grasp what it means. A few weeks ago, Nagaraj was in Toronto for the Asso-

ciation to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB) Deans Conference. There were 700 peers from across the world.

"A good part of my discussions with them was around AI," he says with a smile. SPJIMR has been ranked fourth in the BT-MDRA Best B-Schools Survey.